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PEANUT BUTTER FORMULA

Practical Small-Scale Production Module

Basic and premium formulas for Zimbabwean learners and small businesses

Inside this module

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Prepared for Arachis students - Food manufacturing starter lesson

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This document is prepared for Arachis Online Training students. It is intended for practical learning and small-scale business preparation.

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Important: Peanut butter is a food product. Work cleanly, use safe raw materials, and follow local food safety requirements before selling to the public.

1. Product Overview

Peanut butter is made by roasting good-quality groundnuts, removing skins, grinding into paste, and mixing with salt, sugar, and optional oil or vegetable fat. The most important success factors are clean peanuts, correct roasting, fine grinding, hygienic packing, and attractive labeling.

Business use: This formula can be used for home production, tuckshop supply, school lunch markets, local shops, and small branded food production after proper testing.

2. Formula A - Basic Smooth Peanut Butter

Batch size: 1 kg peanut paste / approximately 1.05 kg finished product depending on additions.

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
Roasted groundnuts / peanuts	1 kg	Main ingredient and natural oil source
Salt	8-12 g	Balances taste and improves flavour
Fine sugar	20-40 g	Adds mild sweetness and improves market taste
Cooking oil / peanut oil	20-50 ml	Softens texture and supports smoother grinding
Optional margarine / vegetable fat	20-40 g	Improves creaminess and body

Use the lower sugar and oil range for a natural taste. Use the higher range for a sweeter, softer product.

3. Formula B - Premium Creamy Peanut Butter

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
High-quality roasted groundnuts	1 kg	Main ingredient, best flavour and aroma
Salt	8-10 g	Flavour balance
Icing sugar / very fine sugar	30-50 g	Smooth sweetness without gritty texture
Peanut oil / sunflower oil	30-60 ml	Smooth, spreadable texture
Vegetable shortening / margarine	30-50 g	Creamy mouthfeel and better spreadability
Optional honey	20-30 g	Premium flavour note; use carefully to avoid overpowering taste

Premium version is better for branded retail packs because it has a smoother texture and richer taste.

4. Equipment Needed

- Roasting pan, oven, drum roaster, or heavy pot
- Peanut butter grinder, milling machine, or strong blender for small batches
- Weighing scale
- Clean trays and bowls

- Spoons or spatulas
- Hair cover, apron, gloves, and clean cloths
- Clean dry bottles, jars, or plastic containers
- Labels and marker or printed stickers

5. Step-by-Step Production Method

Step 1 - Sort the groundnuts

Remove stones, dust, rotten nuts, mouldy nuts, black nuts, and nuts with a bad smell. This is the most important quality control step.

Step 2 - Roast

Roast until golden brown with a strong roasted smell. For an oven, use about 160-180 degrees Celsius for 15-25 minutes. For pan roasting, use medium heat and stir continuously.

Step 3 - Cool

Spread the peanuts on a clean tray and allow them to cool. Do not pack or grind them while they are very hot.

Step 4 - Remove skins

Rub the peanuts gently and winnow using a tray, basket, or fan. Some skin can remain, but too much skin can make the paste bitter.

Step 5 - Grind

Grind until the peanuts release oil and become a paste. For smooth peanut butter, grind 2-3 times. For crunchy peanut butter, keep some roasted peanuts aside, crush them, and mix them in after grinding.

Step 6 - Add salt, sugar, oil, and optional fat

Add ingredients gradually. Mix thoroughly until uniform. Avoid adding water.

Step 7 - Pack

Pack into clean, completely dry containers while the peanut butter is soft. Seal immediately.

Step 8 - Label and store

Label with product name, ingredients, net weight, production date, best-before date, contact number, and storage instructions.

6. Food Safety and Quality Control

Never use mouldy peanuts. Peanuts that have been stored in damp conditions can develop dangerous mould contamination. Bad peanuts must be discarded, not roasted for use.

Control Point	What to Check	Action
Raw peanuts	No mould, no bad smell, no stones, no wetness	Sort carefully before roasting
Roasting	Even golden colour, not burnt	Control heat and stir regularly
Moisture	No water added at any stage	Use dry utensils and dry containers
Hygiene	Clean hands, clean table, covered hair	Use gloves, apron, and sanitized equipment
Packaging	Containers dry and sealed	Close immediately after filling

7. Packaging and Labeling Guide

Recommended pack sizes: 250 g, 375 g, 500 g, and 1 kg. Start with 250 g and 500 g because they are easier to sell in local markets.

- Brand name
- Product name: Peanut Butter
- Ingredients list
- Net weight
- Production date
- Best-before date
- Storage instructions
- Producer contact number

Suggested storage statement: Store in a cool, dry place. Use a clean spoon after opening. Stir if natural oil separates.

8. Shelf Life Guide

For clean small-scale production, expect about 1-2 months for basic homemade peanut butter and about 2-4 months when the peanuts are very dry, properly roasted, packed in dry sealed containers, and stored well. Always test your own batches before large-scale selling.

9. Common Problems and Solutions

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
Too thick	Not enough oil or not ground enough	Add oil little by little and grind again
Too runny	Too much added oil	Reduce oil in next batch; mix with thicker paste if available
Bitter taste	Burnt peanuts or too much skin	Roast at lower heat and remove more skins
Bad smell	Old, damp, or mouldy peanuts	Discard batch and improve raw material selection
Gritty texture	Sugar too coarse or grinding incomplete	Use fine sugar/icing sugar and grind longer
Oil separates	Natural separation or too much oil	Stir before use; reduce added oil next batch

10. Simple Costing Example

Use this method for pricing: Total ingredient cost + container cost + label cost + transport + labour + profit = selling price.

Example Item	Amount
1 kg groundnuts	USD 2.00
Sugar, salt, oil, fat	USD 0.30
4 x 250 g containers and labels	USD 0.50
Estimated total cost	USD 2.80
Selling 4 x 250 g at USD 1.00 each	USD 4.00 sales
Estimated gross profit before other costs	USD 1.20

Adjust the numbers using your actual local prices. Good packaging can allow better pricing because customers trust clean, professional products.

11. Final Student Checklist

- ☐ Peanuts sorted and clean
- ☐ Peanuts roasted evenly without burning
- ☐ No water added
- ☐ Equipment cleaned and dried
- ☐ Formula weighed correctly
- ☐ Containers clean and dry
- ☐ Labels attached
- ☐ Batch date recorded
- ☐ Small batch tested before selling widely

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